



BETTERLIFE
International Organisation

Annual Report

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Overview

In 2023, BetterLife International Organization shifted its focus towards smart and sustainable agriculture, recognizing the critical role it plays in enhancing food security, promoting environmental sustainability, and empowering communities. Our key initiatives included the establishment of the BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited, the implementation of biogas plants, and the promotion of agroecology practices to combat the spread of genetically modified organisms (GMOs). Through targeted programs, we reached diverse communities, including refugee host communities, empowering them with the knowledge and resources needed to adopt sustainable farming practices.



This report details our significant accomplishments in 2023, highlighting the success of key initiatives such as the establishment of the BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited, the installation of 48 biogas plants in Western Uganda, and our comprehensive agroecology programs aimed at combating GMOs. We engaged thousands of individuals through sustainable agriculture training, reaching refugee host communities with essential farming skills and establishing 10 boreholes to improve access to water. Additionally, our commitment to environmental sustainability saw the distribution of 65 million tree seedlings across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania. These impactful efforts were made possible through the generous support of our partners, donors, and community stakeholders, enabling us to empower vulnerable populations and promote resilience in the face of climate change.

BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited

We established the BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited in Western Uganda, showcasing sustainable agricultural practices. This farm focuses on dairy farming, where we implemented organic farming methods to ensure high-quality milk production while maintaining animal welfare.



BetterLife Agro- Tourism Farm

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Our Agro Ecology Workshops specifically targeted widowed women in refugee and host communities. These workshops provided hands-on training in sustainable farming practices, including organic gardening and crop rotation. As a result, participating women gained valuable skills that enabled them to cultivate their own food sustainably, leading to increased self-sufficiency and improved economic independence within their households.

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The sustainable farming techniques taught in our workshops directly contributed to improved food security for the widowed women and their families. By implementing these practices, the women were able to grow diverse and nutritious crops, significantly reducing their dependence on external food sources. This increased access to fresh produce not only improved their families' diets but also enhanced overall health and well-being in the community.

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Through the implementation of agroecological practices learned in the workshops, the widowed women became vital agents of change in their communities. Their commitment to sustainable farming methods promoted biodiversity and improved soil health, fostering environmental stewardship among their peers.

Biogas Plant Installation

Our efforts led to the installation of 48 biogas plants in various regions, particularly in rural communities. These plants provided renewable energy for over 1,200 households, reducing reliance on firewood and lowering greenhouse gas emissions. The biogas systems also promoted sustainable waste management by converting agricultural waste into energy.

Each biogas plant has the capacity to serve approximately 25 households, leading to a significant reduction in greenhouse gas emissions. By converting organic waste into biogas, these plants also contribute to improved sanitation and hygiene by eliminating open waste disposal practices. In total, the installation of these biogas plants has positively impacted over 1,200 households, allowing families to save time and resources that would otherwise be spent on firewood collection. The transition to renewable energy not only supports environmental conservation but also promotes better health outcomes for families by reducing indoor air pollution.

We successfully installed 48 biogas plants in various rural communities, including Kisoro, Kabale, Mbarara, and Masaka. These plants were strategically located to serve households and smallholder farmers, providing a reliable source of clean energy for cooking and lighting while reducing dependency on firewood. The biogas systems utilize organic waste from agricultural activities and livestock, transforming it into usable energy and minimizing waste pollution in these communities.

We have improved the livelihoods of vulnerable communities while addressing pressing environmental challenges.



Engaging Refugee Host Communities

In 2023, BetterLife International Organization made significant strides in engaging refugee and host communities across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania, focusing on building resilience through sustainable agriculture, environmental education, and resource access. One of our primary objectives was to provide refugees and their host communities with the tools and knowledge to achieve food security and self-sufficiency through sustainable farming practices. In South Sudan, particularly in Rhino Camp and Kakuma Refugee Camp, we conducted over 20 training sessions that reached more than 1,500 participants, focusing on agroecology, crop diversification, and water management techniques.

A major focus of our refugee engagement involved introducing sustainable farming techniques tailored to the environmental challenges faced by refugee-hosting areas. These sessions emphasized the importance of using natural farming methods, such as crop rotation, organic fertilizers, and integrated pest management, to increase food production without relying on external inputs.

Moreover, we recognized the vital role of women in these communities and took deliberate steps to engage refugee women in our programs. We organized workshops for 600 women on sustainable farming, financial literacy, and entrepreneurship, empowering them to take leadership roles in community food production and environmental conservation.



Tree Planting & Growing Initiative

We undertook an ambitious tree planting initiative aimed at restoring degraded ecosystems, combating climate change, and promoting agroforestry practices across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania. The initiative resulted in the successful distribution and planting of 65 million tree seedlings, with a focus on areas vulnerable to deforestation and land degradation.

Overall, the tree planting initiative reached over 120 communities across the three countries, engaging thousands of local residents in reforestation efforts. We partnered with 30 schools in these regions to establish environmental clubs, where students actively participated in planting trees and learning about the importance of forest conservation.

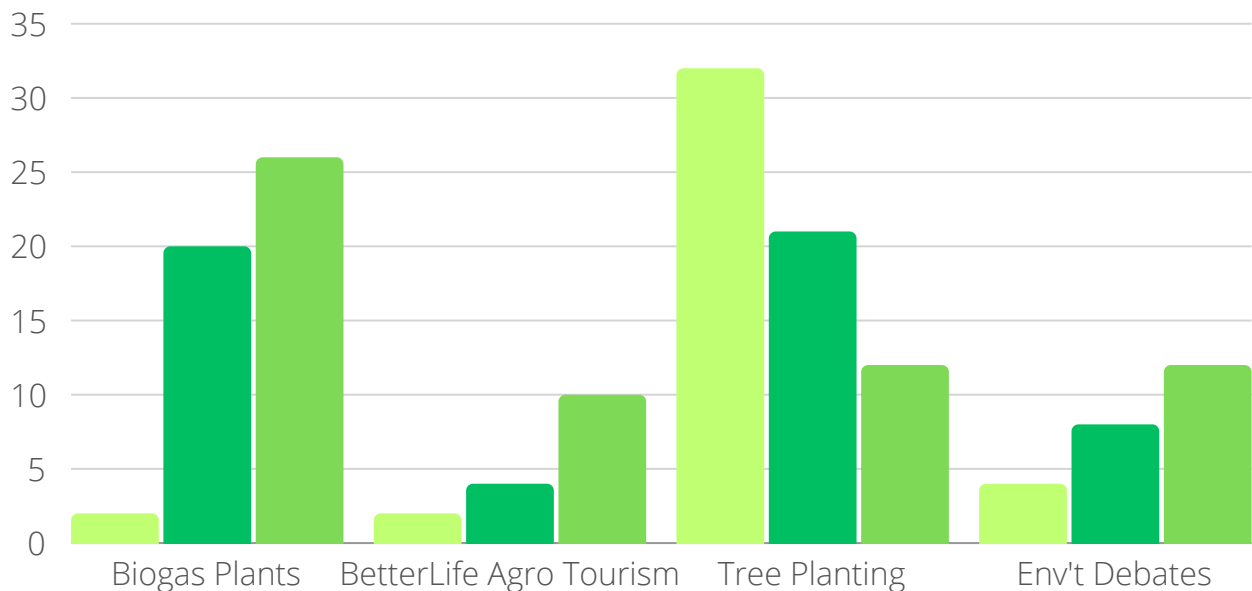
In Uganda, where deforestation rates have been alarmingly high, we distributed 25 million tree seedlings in rural and urban areas, with a particular emphasis on regions like Western Uganda, Mount Elgon, and the Albertine Rift. These regions are critical biodiversity hotspots and play a key role in regulating the climate and supporting livelihoods.

The seedlings included a mix of indigenous species such as *Grevillea robusta*, *Albizia*, and *Markhamia lutea*, chosen for their fast growth, ability to improve soil fertility, and economic benefits through agroforestry. Many of the trees were planted alongside crop fields, helping local farmers integrate sustainable land-use practices by combining agriculture and forestry.



A Year in Review

In 2023, BetterLife International Organization continued to drive transformative change across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania through innovative, community-driven initiatives. Our focus on smart and sustainable agriculture led to the establishment of the BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited in Western Uganda, showcasing eco-friendly farming practices such as dairy farming and biogas production. We installed 48 biogas plants across rural communities, providing clean, renewable energy to over 1,200 households and significantly reducing reliance on firewood.



Biogas Plants

This year, we installed 48 biogas plants across rural communities in Western Uganda, particularly in Kisoro, Kabale, Mbarara, and Masaka. These biogas systems converted organic waste into renewable energy, reducing deforestation by minimizing reliance on firewood. The biogas plants served over 1,200 households, improving their energy security and sanitation by managing waste more effectively. As a result, indoor air quality in homes improved significantly, reducing health issues caused by smoke from traditional wood stoves, while also cutting down on greenhouse gas emissions.

BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited

We established the BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited in Western Uganda as a model for smart and sustainable farming. The farm features diverse activities such as dairy farming, bio gas production, and agroecology practices aimed at fighting GMOs. It served as both a learning hub and a tourist destination, attracting farmers, researchers, and eco-tourists interested in sustainable agriculture. The farm's focus on climate-smart agricultural methods provided local farmers with practical knowledge to improve productivity while preserving the environment, boosting local economies and promoting eco-friendly farming practices.



Tree Planting Initiative

Our tree planting initiative was one of the largest in our organization's history, with over 65 million tree seedlings distributed and planted across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania.

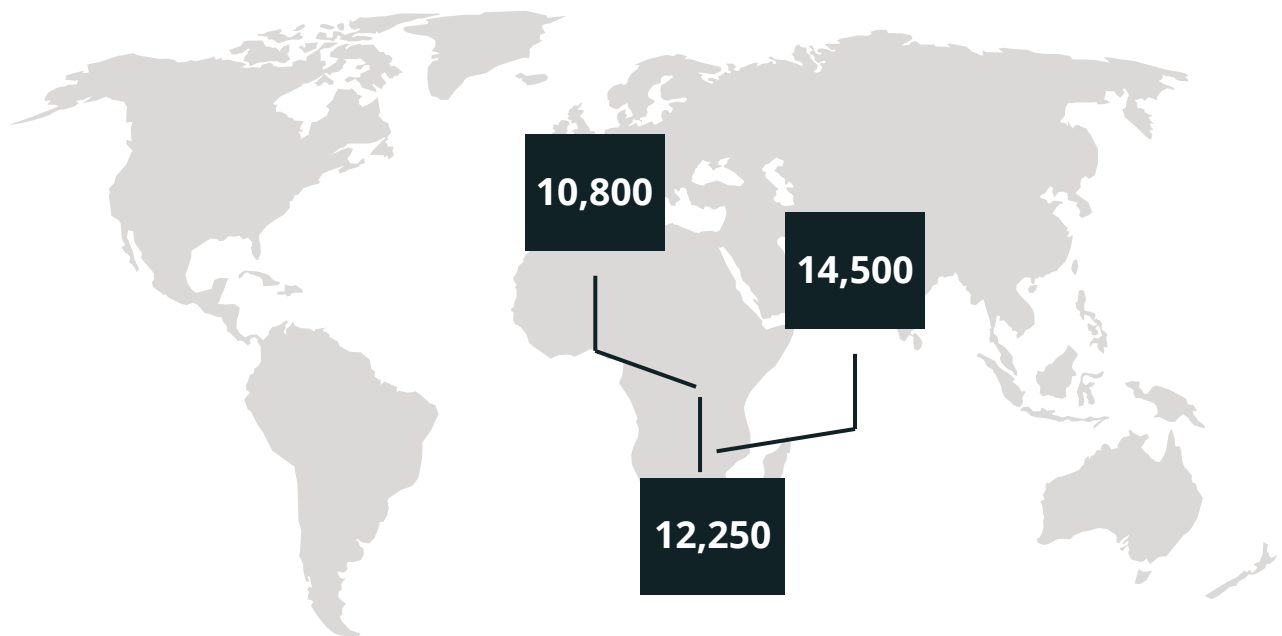
The trees included a mix of indigenous species that contribute to ecosystem restoration, carbon sequestration, and improved soil fertility. In Uganda, 25 million seedlings were planted in regions like Mount Elgon and the Albertine Rift, while 10 million seedlings were planted in South Sudan, particularly around refugee settlements, to combat land degradation. This initiative directly impacted more than 120 communities, helping restore forests and improve agricultural practices through agroforestry.



Environmental Debates and School Engagement

We actively engaged schools in environmental education through environmental debates held in 30 rural primary schools across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania.

These debates empowered students to discuss pressing environmental issues, such as deforestation and climate change, fostering a generation of climate-conscious leaders. Over 2,500 students participated, enhancing their understanding of sustainable practices and encouraging them to become ambassadors for environmental conservation in their communities. This program not only raised awareness but also fostered community-driven environmental responsibility.



A Global Review



Across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania, BetterLife International directly impacted over 37,550 people through its initiatives in sustainable agriculture, renewable energy, environmental conservation, and community engagement.

Our initiatives were tailored to address the unique challenges faced by vulnerable communities, particularly in rural and underserved areas.

Summary

In 2023, BetterLife International continued to drive impactful change across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania, focusing on sustainable solutions that empower communities and combat the climate crisis. Our work spanned environmental conservation, renewable energy, and agricultural innovation, reaching thousands of people and making a measurable difference in vulnerable areas

- **65 Million Trees Planted**

We distributed and planted 65 million tree seedlings across three countries, restoring ecosystems, enhancing agroforestry practices, and improving livelihoods in over 120 communities.

- **48 Biogas Plants Installed**

Installed 48 biogas plants in rural Uganda, benefiting 1,200 households with clean, renewable energy, reducing firewood dependence, and improving waste management practices.

- **Empowering Refugees Through Agriculture**

Trained over 1,500 refugees in sustainable farming techniques and provided clean water access to 3,500 people through the installation of 10 boreholes in South Sudan's refugee-hosting communities.

- **BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm**

Launched the BetterLife Agro Tourism Farm Limited in Western Uganda, promoting smart agriculture, dairy farming, bio gas production, and eco-tourism, serving as a learning hub for farmers and researchers.

What Next?

In 2024, BetterLife International will deepen its focus on empowering refugee communities, expanding our sustainable farming programs and providing greater access to clean water through additional boreholes in South Sudan and Uganda. We aim to equip more refugees with climate-smart agricultural skills to improve food security and livelihoods.

Additionally, we will venture into digital agriculture, introducing mobile platforms and smart farming tools to help farmers access real-time data on weather, soil health, and crop management.



Work with Us

At BetterLife International Organization, we believe that collaboration is key to creating sustainable solutions for our planet. We invite you to join us in our mission to empower communities, promote environmental sustainability, and combat climate change across Uganda, South Sudan, and Tanzania.

How You Can Help?

- **Partnerships:** Collaborate with us to enhance our programs and reach more vulnerable communities.
- **Funding Support:** Your financial contributions can help expand our initiatives, such as establishing more Plastic Banks, Green Libraries, and Eco Labs.
- **Volunteer Opportunities:** Join our team as a volunteer to engage directly with communities and support our educational programs.
- **Advocacy:** Help amplify our message by advocating for sustainable practices and climate resilience in your network.



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Building Hope